



Committee Report

KEY DECISION OR FOR INFORMATION: For Information

COMMITTEE: Transport and Connectivity Committee

DATE: 23 October 2025

TITLE: Workplace Parking Levy Update

Ward(s): Citywide

Officer presenting the report: Adam Crowther **Job title:** Head of City Transport

Committee Chair: Ed Plowden

Executive Director lead: John Smith: Executive Director for Growth & Regeneration

Proposal origin: Committee Chair

Purpose of Report: To update the committee on progress with the Workplace Parking Levy Outline Business Case (OBC) and to outline progress on key project milestones.

Evidence Base:

1. In September 2024, the Transport and Connectivity Committee approved to spend up to £1million on the Stage One development of a Workplace Parking Levy (WPL) project including preparation of an OBC. In May 2025, an update report was brought to the Committee to provide an overview of the planned key project milestones. It was agreed that a report would be brought back to committee once key project milestones were met.
2. A WPL forms a potential part of Bristol City Council's transport strategy and is outlined in Joint Local Transport Plan 4 and the Bristol Transport Strategy as a key demand management measure aimed at tackling congestion, particularly at peak times, and as a means of providing significant additional revenue for transport improvements across the city. The introduction of a WPL would help discourage car commuting and help increase the use of alternative modes such as walking, cycling and public transport which would in turn, improve people's health and the local environment and can free up land for more productive use.
3. There are three main stages to the development of a WPL scheme which are outlined below. An estimated timescale is provided to indicate how long it should take to complete each stage.

Stage	Timescale
Outline Business Case	April 2025 – April 2026 (1 year)
Public Consultation, Full Business Case and Scheme Approval to Secretary of State for Transport	May 2026 – December 2027 (1 year to 18 months)
Implementation and Operation	January 2028 – December 2029 (1-2 years)

4. The Stage One programme which is currently underway, is split into five key workstreams, with a planned end date for all workstreams by April 2026. The timescales for some tasks have shifted since last reported in May 2025 due to procurement and contractual issues associated with appointing a consultant to assist with the project. However, the work is still set to conclude by April 2026.

Stage	Original timescale	Revised date
1. Supporting studies and information	April to June 2025	April to Sept 2025
2. Surveys and data collection	June to September 2025	October to November 2025
3. Modelling, forecasting and impact assessment	September to November 2025	November to January 2026
4. WPL scheme development	October to March 2026	November to March 2026
5. WPL package and final OBC	December to April 2026	January to April 2026

5. In stage 2, data will be gathered about existing businesses in Bristol, as well as employment projections for allocated growth sites, and this will be used to estimate the number of potentially liable Workplace Parking Places (WPPs) that might be included in a WPL scheme for the city. Initial engagement will take place with employer representative groups to gather their input on the approach being taken in subsequent stages of the project, such as the geographical areas in scope for the modelling.
6. The data gathered in stage 2 will be used to undertake the modelling, forecasting and impact assessments in stage 3. This work will help to forecast potential revenue to be generated by the scheme, as well as identifying other likely impacts on factors such as congestion, air quality and economic outcomes.
7. At the end of the stage 4 workstream, a draft scheme definition will be put forward, which will include the potential boundaries of the scheme, proposed charge, parking space thresholds, possible exemptions and hours of operation. Engagement will take place with key employer representative groups in this stage, following on from initial engagement in earlier stages of the project. Wider public consultation is not typically undertaken for a WPL project at the OBC stage.
8. In terms of progress to date, the Project Team has been formed and work has started on the Strategic Case for the OBC. Supporting data and information has been collated for the OBC, and to assist with the planned modelling and forecasting work. This includes datasets

on air quality, congestion, carbon emissions, existing public parking stock, travel to work patterns and employment statistics.

9. A competitive tendering exercise has been completed to appoint a consultant to assist with the project. Five consultants were invited to tender, and two consultants submitted a bid. Systra have been awarded the work, and an inception meeting was held with them on 17th September 2025.
10. We have officially engaged Nottingham City Council to provide expert advice and act as a critical friend to help guide the project with us. To date they have contributed to the development of the project plan, the preparation and evaluation of the tender documentation, the initial communications and marketing strategy, and stakeholder management. Officers and some committee members will be undertaking a study visit to Nottingham late October to learn more about their WPL scheme and the benefits it has brought to the city.
11. The Communications Team at BCC is engaged and are currently drawing up a Communications Plan for the project. This will be firmed up once the consultant has confirmed when the workplace surveys are likely to commence.
12. In terms of current and forecast spend, approximately £100k is allocated to be spent on the project in 2025/26.

Alternative options considered:

No alternative options are currently recommended as the approach is in line with advice received from Nottingham City Council who are the only local authority in the country to successfully implement at WPL so far.

When the project comes to committee for approval at subsequent stages of the programme, different options will be presented from the modelling.

Officer Recommendations:

That the Committee for Transport and Connectivity notes this update report.

Corporate Strategy alignment:

1. **Children and young people** - improved access to transport schemes and initiatives will help ensure all children and young people have a good start in life.
2. **Economy and skills** – the scheme will help tackle congestion which can have a significant negative impact on economic growth. Revenue from a WPL scheme will help ensure people have improved access to jobs, skills and training.
3. **Environment and sustainability** – the scheme will help reduce congestion and in turn will work towards BCC carbon and air quality ambitions. It will also contribute to BCC climate and ecological emergencies.
4. **Healthcare and wellbeing** – the scheme will help tackle health inequalities by providing people with improved access to a range of sustainable transport opportunities such as walking and cycling that will help improve their health and wellbeing.
5. **Homes and communities** – the scheme can help increase revenue towards transport schemes that can provide more healthy, resilient and inclusive neighbourhoods.

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6. **Transport and connectivity** – a WPL can enable investment in a more reliable, convenient and safer network of public transport and infrastructure for walking and cycling.
7. **Effective development organisation** – the project aligns with our One City approach of working with our partners to deliver long-term ambitions for the city.

City Benefits:

1. The introduction of a WPL has benefits associated with a reduction in car use and a subsequent increase in the use of alternative modes such as walking, cycling and public transport. In turn this will have a positive impact on people's health.
2. A reduction in car trips into the city centre is likely to result in a reduction in the amount of carbon emissions.
3. A reduction in the number of car trips will have a beneficial impact on air quality.
4. Improved air quality and a reduction in traffic noise will have a beneficial impact on health.
5. A reduction in car-based trips will help reduce congestion and the negative impacts associated with this such as delays and the negative impact this has on economic growth.
6. The greatest potential benefit will be through the transport measures/schemes that can be funded through the revenue raised by a WPL. The revenue should be substantial, predictable and locally generated and will significantly help BCC to develop and deliver transport infrastructure and initiatives in the longer term.
7. The additional revenue generated could fund more sustainable transport options which are particularly beneficial to younger, older people and disabled people who tend to have more limited access to a car and rely more on public transport to access key services such as education and healthcare.

Consultation Details:

1. A WPL is referenced in and consulted on as part of Joint Local Transport Plan 4 and the Bristol Transport Strategy.
2. A Stakeholder Management Strategy and accompanying Communications Plan form a key part of the Stage One work.
3. A Stakeholder Radar has already been produced as part of the Feasibility Study undertaken by Nottingham CC; this outlines those stakeholders who will be both vital and necessary to engage and consult with as part of the programme. Further information on this is outlined from page 38 onwards of the Feasibility Study (see Appendix A).
4. Following approval of this report, a more detailed project plan will be produced which will further outline the stages at which consultation will take place throughout the programme.
5. Formal public consultation is proposed as part of Stage Two of the WPL project if it progresses beyond the OBC stage.
6. Further updates will be brought to the Transport Connectivity Committee as the project progresses.
7. At the end of the Stage One programme, a proposal will be brought back to the Transport and Connectivity Policy Committee for approval and to progress to the next stage.

Background Documents:

1. [Appendix A: Feasibility Study Report for a WPL Scheme in Bristol – Final Draft.](#)
2. [12 September 2024 Transport and Connectivity Committee Workplace Parking Levy report](#)
3. [15 May 2025 Transport and Connectivity Committee Workplace Parking Levy report](#)

Revenue Cost	£ 1million	Source of Revenue Funding	Clean Air Zone fund
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Capital Cost	£	Source of Capital Funding	
One off cost ☐	Ongoing	Saving Proposal ☐	If yes - existing or new saving? N/A
cost ☒		OR Income generation proposal ☐	

Professional comments section:

- 1. Finance Advice:** This report is providing an update on the development of a workplace parking levy (WPL) within Bristol. The WPL is intended to reduce congestion, improve air quality, and generate revenue for sustainable transport improvements. Previous approval was given to use £1 million of CAZ funding to develop this scheme and this is captured within CAZ funding monitoring. It is anticipated that the levy will replenish the CAZ funding pot within a few years of operation, however finance has not been provided with detail to support this. To date, approximately £26,000 has been spent developing the levy and it is presumed that most of the £1 million allocated will be spent within the 2026/27 financial year.

Future implementation will require IT systems to manage and enforce the levy. No systems have yet been scoped, which could pose integration or cost risks later.

In addition, effective consultation is critical, especially given the potential impact on employers and commuters. Reputational risk for the council, along with risk of public resistance is high, if engagement is not well managed.

Finance Business Partner: Vivi Sargioti, Finance Business Partner - Growth & Regeneration, 15 September 2025

- 2. Legal Advice:** As this is an update report on progress towards the OBC there are no specific legal implications arising from the report.

Legal Team Manager: Joanne Mansfield 11 September 2025

- 3. Implications on IT:** There are likely to be I.T. systems needed to support and manage WPL. I.T. are supportive of the proposal and can be engaged through the existing work request process.

IT Team Leader: Alex Simpson – Lead Enterprise Architect – 10 September 2025

- 4. HR Advice:** There are no HR implications evident

HR Partner: Celia Williams, HR Business Partner, 25 September 2025

APPENDICES

Appendix A – Further essential background / detail on the proposal	YES
Appendix B – Equality Impact Assessment (EqIA)	YES
Appendix C – Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA)	NO
Appendix D – Decision Risk Assessment	NO

Appendix E – Exempt Information	NO	
Appendix F – Details of consultation carried out - internal and external		NO
Appendix G – Options appraisal matrix	NO	
Appendix H – Business case / financial analysis	NO	